CELERITER
Quick Step



Move one hex in any direction

MOVE

RECEDERE
Retreat



Move one hex away from your opponent

MOVE

DECLINARE
Sidestep



Move to a side hex

MOVE

PROCEDERE
Advance



Move each second

MOVE

LUMBER



Move each second

MOVE

CIRCUMIRE
Circle



Move up to once each second to maintain your attack range

MOVE

PUNCTIM
Stab



Cheap attack

ATTACK

SUB FERIRE
Low Attack



Low attack

ATTACK ★

ICTUS DESUPER
High Attack



High attack

ATTACK ★

REDOPPIO
Triple Strike



Attack
Attack Attack

ATTACK

DEVITARE
Duck



Evade high attacks

DEFEND

ELUDERE
Dodge



Evade the attack; move one hex attempting to get out of range

DEFEND/MOVE

SALIRE
Jump



Evade low attacks

DEFEND

DEFENDERE
Parry



Deflect one attack

DEFEND

TRUDERE
Shove



Shove target one hex and prone
Move into the vacant hex

ATTACK

CIRCUMVERSIO
Spin



Spin to win!

FLOURISH

SALVETE
Salute



Raise your weapon to the crowd

FLOURISH

PROSILIRE
Lunge



Move
Attack

MOVE/ATTACK

RITIRATA
Attack and Move



Attack
Move

ATTACK/MOVE

DEFENDERE ET PERCUTERE
Counterattack



Defend
Attack

DEFEND/ATTACK

CORONA
Crown Guard



Block with style

DEFEND/FLOURISH

SURGE FESTINA
Kip-Up



Snap from prone to standing

FLOURISH

GLADIUS



Range 1

GEAR - WEAPON

SICA



Range 1. Once per round: ignore shields

GEAR - WEAPON

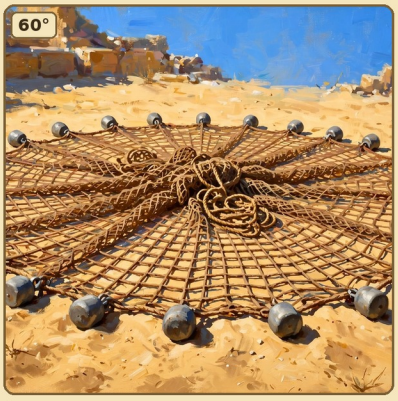
TRIDENT



Range 2 only

GEAR - WEAPON

RETE



Range 1 or 2. Once per round.
Target prone on successful attack

GEAR - WEAPON

SCUTUM



Block attacks
each dents this shield

GEAR - DEFENSE - SHIELD

PARMA



Block range-1 attacks
each dents this shield

GEAR - DEFENSE - SHIELD

MANICA



Block attacks
each dents this armor

GEAR - DEFENSE

GALEA



Block attacks
each dents this helm

GEAR - DEFENSE

CASSIS



Block attacks
each dents this helm

GEAR - DEFENSE

Rufus the Ox

Brute. Hits like a siege engine

26	14	12	1
WATER	BLOOD	RALLY	UNARMED



Once per round, Punctim
(Stab) as an additional action

Vela the Eel

She moves like a reed in the wind

22	8	8	1
WATER	BLOOD	RALLY	UNARMED



Once per round, Eludere
(Dodge) one attack

Cassius the Peacock

Always working the crowd

24	10	8	1
WATER	BLOOD	RALLY	UNARMED



Once per round, +1 glory for a flourish played
within reach of an opponent

Drusa the Wall

Built like a brick forica

24	12	10	1
WATER	BLOOD	RALLY	UNARMED



Once per round, Defendere
(Parry) as an additional action

GETTING STARTED

Your first bout

1. Pick a champion. Set your water and blood markers to their starting values. Glory starts at 0
2. Equip your Arma (gear): weapons and shields for your hands, armor for your arms and head
3. Pompa: announce your champion and Arma (gear)
4. Randomly pick the starting player. They get the first player marker.
5. Play your first round (see EACH ROUND)

Example: I pick Vela, set my water to 22 and blood to 8, glory at 0. Gladius in one hand, rete in the other. We flip a coin. I get the marker. Round 1 begins

EACH ROUND

At the start of every round

1. Advance the round track
2. If your deck has fewer than 6 cards, shuffle your discard pile back into it
3. Choose 6 cards from your deck to build a fresh hand (planning)
4. Arma (gear) upkeep: pay water equal to your gear's water icons. You may shed gear first
5. Play the six seconds: see EACH SECOND
6. End of round: +1 glory for the center hex, -1 for each edge fighter
7. After round 6: most glory wins. If a fighter's blood hits zero, they're out. Last one standing wins immediately

Example: Round 3. I advance the tracker, my stab stays on the track, I pick 6 cards. My scutum and manica cost 3 water. I pay it, and we're ready

EACH SECOND

CHOOSE → SHOW → ACT → BURN → REPEAT

1. CHOOSE: secretly pick a card from your hand, hold it in front of you and say "Parati!"
2. SHOW: all players reveal simultaneously, placing cards on the burn-down track at matching heat
3. ACT: in player order: take your card's actions (see TAKING ACTIONS)
4. BURN: slide all cards one slot right. Cards burning off: pay their water cost (glory scores on success, not at burn-off)
5. REPEAT: pass the first player marker right. Next second
6. If you hit zero water, see OUT OF WATER

TAKING ACTIONS

On your turn during ACT, in player order

1. All face-up cards in your track are active this second
2. You can take your actions in any order
3. You can skip any action you don't want to take
4. If you attack, see ATTACK RESOLUTION
5. If you start your turn at the edge, you can discard a card from your hand to Rally (get water) and/or Change your Arma (gear)

Example: I've been lumbering for two seconds and counterattacking for one, now I'm also stabbing. I don't care to move because I'm in range of Cassius, so I'll attack him twice

ATTACK RESOLUTION

When an attack card resolves

1. Pair each attack with a weapon in your hand. If you run out of weapons, the extra attacks are unarmed
2. Say "[Attack name] [Weapon name]!", like "Punctim gladio!"
3. Declare your target and give them a chance to defend
4. Successful attacks spill the defender's blood on the sand. An attack card scores its glory when the attack lands, weapon or unarmed
5. Losing 3 or more blood in a second makes the defender prone (see GOING PRONE)

Example: I say 'Punctim gladio!' as I stab Cassius with my gladius and kick. Both get through: 2 + 1 = 3 blood, so Cassius is prone

GOING PRONE

Knocked down in the sand

1. Spilling 3 or more blood in one second makes the defender prone
2. Prone players waste the next second getting up, play a card face down, except KIP-UP
3. While prone, you cannot attack, defend, or move
4. If KIP-UP is in play or played in the next second, prone is ignored and play continues
5. After one full second prone, you stand back up and rejoin the fray
6. While prone, raise a finger ("ad digitum") to concede and ask for missio. Every other player's up-thumb gives you 1 glory

Example: Cassius stabs me with his gladius and kicks me. 3 blood, I'm prone. I spend all of next second getting up while he circles. Then I'm back on my feet

OUT OF WATER

At zero water, you are crawling

1. While crawling, the only action you can take is moving one hex per second toward the edge (discard a card each second)
2. Attacking a crawling fighter costs 1 glory
3. Reach the edge: Rally (get water) and/or Change your Arma (gear). Rally at most once per round
4. Rejoin the fray

Example: I'm out of water with three cards left. They all become crawl. I drag myself one hex per second toward the edge. I reach it, rally back 12 water, swap my scutum for a parma, and I'm back in the fight

BASIC RULES

Free movement: the simple intro version

1. Movement is free. No facing restrictions, move in any direction
2. No 60° turn limits. Turn as much as you like, whenever you like
3. Weapon arcs don't matter. If a target is in range, you can hit it
4. Shields block any attack from any direction
5. Wheel is just a flourish

Example: I'm facing Cassius but want to hit Drusa behind me. In basic rules I just turn and stab. No penalty, no facing to track

ADVANCED RULES

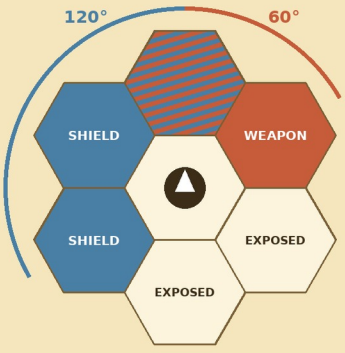
Facing, 60° turns, and weapon arcs

1. Facing matters: you have a front, sides, and back
2. You can change your facing 60° as a free action at any time during your action turn. The Wheel card turns you 120°
3. Weapons hit in their arc: 60° for most (forward + your weapon hand's side)
4. Shields block in their arc: Scutum 120°, Parma 60°
5. See the WEAPON & SHIELD ARCS card for the visual

Example: I sidestep left and turn 60° to face Cassius, keeping my scutum toward him. My gladius covers my front and right. Drusa on my left is safe this second

WEAPON & SHIELD ARCS

Example: shield in left hand, weapon in right hand



- A weapon hits the forward hex and the hex on its hand's side (60° arc)
- A shield covers the two hexes on its hand's side (120° arc)

The rear is always exposed

Mirror the arcs if your Arma (gear) swaps hands